NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

MIL-S-3951D
23 April 1993
SUPERSEDING
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25 July 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SERVICE RIBBONS AND BARS, SERVICE RIBBONS

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the service ribbons and service ribbon bars used by the Department of Defense (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. Service ribbons shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2).

1.2.1 Service ribbons.

Type I - Ribbon covered clip with back strip (single)
Type II - Ribbon covered clip with back strip and bar (single)
Type III - Sewn-on service ribbon

1.2.2 Bars, service ribbon. Service ribbon bars shall be the following sizes as specified (see 6.2).

Size 1 - Single, Regular Size and Double, Miniature Size
Size 2 - Double, Regular Size and Quadruple, Miniature Size
Size 3 - Triple, Regular Size and Sextuple, Miniature Size
Size 4 - Quadruple, Regular Size and Octuple, Miniature Size
Size 5 - Single, Miniature Size
Size 6 - Triple, Miniature Size
Size 7 - Quintuple, Miniature Size
Size 8 - Septuple, Miniature Size

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in preparing this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document.

AMSC N/A FSC 8455
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2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

NN-P-71 - Pallets, Material Handling Wood Stringer Construction 2-Way and 4-Way (Partial)
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set Up

MILITARY

MIL-P-15011 - Pallets, Material Handling, Wood Post Construction, 4-Way Entry
MIL-R-11589 - Ribbon, Awards, General Specification For

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metals; Test Methods

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards and handbooks are available from: Standardization Document Order Desk, Building 4D, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

A-A-50186 Cloth, Buckram, Woven and Nonwoven

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY (TIOH)

4-4-91 - Service Ribbons and Service Ribbon Bars; Assembly and Details

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B-13-12 - Attaching Devices, Heraldic, Prong and Clutch Type

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and specification sheets required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

(Figure 1 and Figure 2 are miniature copies of Institute of Heraldry drawings and are for information only.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-D-3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other information services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related associated detail specifications or MS standards), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Standard sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contracting officer shall furnish a standard sample (see 6.4) of the completely fabricated service ribbon which shall be used for matching color and finish only. Variation from this specification may appear in the standard sample; however, in such cases the specification shall govern.

3.3 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein.

3.3.1 Copper base alloy. The copper base alloy shall be roll polished, free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, nicks, cracks, scratches, segregations and foreign inclusions that will not be removed in later processing. When tested as specified in 4.6.1, the chemical composition of the copper base alloy shall be as specified in Table I.

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TABLE I. Chemical composition of copper base alloys

Alloy	Copper	Nickel 1/	Lead (Max)	Iron (Max)	Manganese (Max)	Zinc	Others (Max)
Yellow Brass	64.0 - 68.5	--	0.15	0.05	--	Remainder	0.15
Red Brass	84.0 - 86.0	--	0.05	0.05	--	Remainder	0.15
Free Cutting Brass	60.0 - 63.0	--	2.5 - 3.75	0.35	--	Remainder	0.50 (Total)
Nickel Silver	63.0 - 65.5 2/	16.5 - 19.5 3/	0.10	0.25	0.50	Remainder	--
Low Brass	78.5 - 81.5	--	0.05	0.05	--	Remainder	0.15

1/ Cobalt counting as nickel.
2/ Copper content for the nickel silver pin only may be 53.5 to 56.5%
3/ When nickel silver is used as a base material, the nickel content shall be not less than 18%.

3.3.2 Ribbon. The rayon ribbon for the service ribbons shall conform to MIL-R-11589 (see 6.2).

3.3.3 Buckram. The buckram for sewn-on ribbons shall conform to Type II, Class 2 of A-A-50186.

3.3.4 Hard Solder. Hard solder shall be a silver alloy solder having a melting point of not less than 1075 degrees Fahrenheit (561.7 degrees Celsius).

3.4 Construction.

3.4.1 Prong and clutch type. The prongs shall be made from nickel silver or hard drawn brass specified in 3.3.1. The prongs and dimensions shall be as shown on Drawing B-13-12 (see Figure 2). The prongs shall be 5/16 inch ± 1/64 inch (0.79 cm ± 0.04 cm) long. The prongs shall be driven, swaged, hard soldered or electronically fused in the locations specified on Drawing 4-4-91 (see Figure 1). Clutches as shown on Drawing B-13-12 (see Figure 2) shall be made from any type brass. When clutches are tested as specified in 4.6.2, it shall not be possible to remove the clutch from the prong without first depressing the release wings.

3.4.2 Prong attachment method.

3.4.2.1 Hard soldered and electronic fusion. Unless otherwise specified, all soldering shall be accomplished using hard solder specified in 3.3.4 or by electronic fusion. Joints shall be clean, smooth, strong and free from burned or reduced areas. There shall be no excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. When hard

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solder is used, the prong shall not separate at the joint when tested as specified in 4.6.3. When fused joints are used, the prong shall not separate at the joint when tested as specified in 4.6.4.

3.4.2.2 Driven or swaged. When driven or swaged, the prongs shall be knurled under the head for a distance of not less than 1/32 inch (0.08 cm). Two prongs shall be forced fitted into the bar with the exposed surface of the head of the prong flush with the bar.

3.4.3 Service ribbons. Service ribbons and service ribbon bars shall be constructed as shown on Drawing 4-4-91 (see Figure 1).

3.4.3.1 Type I. The Type I service ribbon shall consist of a clip specified in 3.4.3.1.1, a ribbon specified in 3.3.2, the back strip specified in 3.4.3.1.2 and assembled as shown on the Drawing 4-4-91 (see Figure 1). The ribbon shall be stretched tautly over the face of the clip. The flange of the clip shall hold the back strip and the ribbon firmly in place. When the cut edges are exposed on the outer ends of the assembled service ribbon, the ribbon edges shall be neatly trimmed and treated with a colorless, transparent adhesive or resin to prevent raveling. Striped ribbon shall be assembled on the clip with stripes centered and aligned, straight and level in the horizontal and/or vertical plane, as applicable.

3.4.3.1.1 Clip. The clip shall be fabricated from any copper base alloy specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on Drawing 4-4-91 (see Figure 1).

3.4.3.1.2 Back strip. The back strip shall be fabricated from any copper base alloy specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on Drawing 4-4-91 (see Figure 1).

3.4.3.2 Type II. The Type II service ribbon shall be as specified in 3.4.3.1, except the assembly shall include a single ribbon bar as shown on Drawing 4-4-91 (see Figure 1).

3.4.3.3 Type III. The Type III service ribbons shall consist of a strip of buckram specified in 3.3.3 and ribbon specified in 3.3.2. The service ribbon shall be fabricated by tautly stretching a 7/8 inch (2.22 cm) long piece of ribbon over a 3/8 inch (0.95 cm) wide strip of buckram so that a 1/8 inch $\pm$ 1/64 inch (0.32 inch $\pm$ 0.04 cm) overlap is available on the back for hand stitching. The edges of each ribbon may be tacked to the buckram with a blind stitch to prevent the buckram center from showing. The lengths of the buckram strip shall be as specified in 3.4.3.3.1. When multiple sewn-on ribbons are ordered, they shall be mounted on a panel of material matching the color and texture of the uniform on which they are to be worn. When mounted on the panel for Army personnel (see 6.2), the rows of ribbons may be together or with a 1/8 inch (0.32 cm) space between them. No spacing between ribbon rows is permitted for Air Force, Navy, Marine Corps and Coast Guard ribbons. The rows shall be stitched to the panel from the back without showing on the front of the ribbon. The panels shall be of sufficient size to allow the edges to be turned under when being stitched to the uniform.

3.4.3.3.1 Buckram strip. The buckram strip shall be 3/8 inch $\pm$ 1/64 inch (0.95 cm $\pm$ 0.04 cm) wide and shall be of the following lengths as applicable.

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Size 1 - Single, Regular Size and Double, Miniature Size
Size 2 - Double, Regular Size and Quadruple, Miniature Size
Size 3 - Triple, Regular Size and Sextuple, Miniature Size
Size 4 - Quadruple, Regular Size and Octuple, Miniature Size
Size 5 - Single, Miniature Size
Size 6 - Triple, Miniature Size
Size 7 - Quintuple, Miniature Size
Size 8 - Septuple, Miniature Size

Size 1	1-3/8 inches + 0 - 1/64 inch	(3.49 cm + 0 - 0.04 cm)
Size 2	2-3/4 inches + 0 - 1/64 inch	(6.99 cm + 0 - 0.04 cm)
Size 3	4-1/8 inches + 0 - 1/64 inch	(10.48 cm + 0 - 0.04 cm)
Size 4	5-1/2 inches + 0 - 1/64 inch	(13.97 cm + 0 - 0.04 cm)
Size 5	11/16 inch + 0 - 1/64 inch	(1.75 cm + 0 - 0.04 cm)
Size 6	1-15/16 inches + 0 - 1/64 inch	(4.92 cm + 0 - 0.04 cm)
Size 7	3-11/16 inches + 0 - 1/64 inch	(9.37 cm + 0 - 0.04 cm)
Size 8	5-1/16 inches + 0 - 1/64 inch	(12.86 cm + 0 - 0.04 cm)

3.4.4 Bars, service ribbon. Service ribbon bars shall be fabricated from any type half hard copper base alloy specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions on Drawing 4-4-91 (see Figure 1). The attaching device shall be prong and clutch type as shown on Drawing B-13-12 (see Figure 2). Prongs and clutches shall be as specified in 3.4.1.

3.5 Finish. Metal parts of the service ribbon and service ribbon bars shall be bright and clean.

3.6 Marking for identification. The back strip of the service ribbon (Types I and II) and the service ribbon bar shall be stamped with the manufacturer's identification mark and the letters "GI" so they are visible after assembly for all Government procurement. For service ribbons and service ribbon bars manufactured for sale under the Heraldic Quality Control Program, the manufacturer shall stamp his hallmark on the back strip and the back of the bar when applicable.

3.7 Workmanship. The service ribbon and service ribbon bars shall be clean, well made and shall meet the acceptable quality provisions established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of Sections 3 and 5. The inspections set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor

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of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements; however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.5 and 4.6.

4.4 First article sample inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article sample (see 3.1) shall be made of a completely finished service ribbon bar, service ribbon or rayon ribbon for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end product examination and tests.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated (see 6.3).

4.5.1 Inspection of components.

4.5.1.1 Testing of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in Table II for the test characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the requirements shall be applicable to the lot average.

TABLE II. Testing of components

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Charac-teristic	Rqm't Para	Test Method	Rqm't applicable to lot average	#determ per sample unit	Results Reported as	Sample Unit
Copper base alloy (1 lb)	Chemical composition	3.3.1 and Table I	Method 111 of FED-STD-151	X	2 (com-posite)	Nearest 0.1% for each element	4 oz. of composite

4.5.2 Certification of compliance. Materials listed below may be accepted on the basis of the contractor's certificate of compliance for requirements specified in applicable paragraphs of this specification.

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COMPONENTS	CHARACTERISTICS	RQM'T PARA
Clip material	Material identification	3.4.3.1.1
Back strip material	Material identification	3.4.3.1.2
Bar material	Material identification	3.4.4
Prongs	Material identification	3.4.1
Clutches	Material identification	3.4.1
Hard solder	Material identification	3.4.2.1

4.5.3 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operation or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements.

REQUIREMENT, OPERATION OR ASSEMBLY	CHARACTERISTICS	RQM'T PARA
Soldering	Use of hard solder	3.4.2.1

4.5.4 Inspection of the end item.

4.5.4.1 Visual examination of the service ribbons or service bar. Examination shall be made at a distance of approximately 16 to 22 inches. The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.5.4.1.1 and 4.5.4.1.2. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.5.4.1.3. The unit of product for the examinations in 4.5.4.1.1 and 4.5.4.1.2 shall be one completely finished service ribbon or service ribbon bar of each type or size, as applicable.

4.5.4.1.1 Examination of service ribbon or service ribbon bar for defects in finish, design, construction and workmanship. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

TABLE III. Defects

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION Major	(*)	Minor
Type and Size of Ribbon	Not as specified.....	x	-	-
	Color is a poor match to the standard or approved sample; or color pattern is not as specified.....	x	-	-
	Finish is not as specified, i.e., is not moire when required.....	-	-	x
	Spot, stain or streak clearly visible affecting appearance.....	x	-	-
	End out, broken or missing yarn, tear, cut, hole, misweave or defective selvage.....	x	-	-
	Smash.....	x	-	-
	Coarse end, knot, slub, uneven texture or other imperfection clearly noticeable.....	x	-	-
	Overall width less than specified.....	x	-	-

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TABLE III. Defects (Continued)

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION Major	(*)	Minor
	Overall width more than 1/16 inch (0.16 cm) wider than specified	x	-	-
	Exposed cut edges of ribbon not even, not neat or not treated to prevent raveling	x	-	-
	Weave at selvage not as specified, i.e., catch cord is not provided or special weave is provided when not specified	-	-	x
Sewn-on Service Ribbon	Buckram strip not as specified	-	-	x
	Multiple ribbon not on panel	-	-	x
	Panel not same material or color of uniform	x	-	-
	Ribbon not tautly stretched over face of the buckram strip	-	*	-
	Damage affecting use or appearance	-	*	-
Ribbon bar, clip, Back Strip and Attaching Device	Any component missing	x	-	-
	Metal component tarnished or evidence of corrosion	x	-	-
	Component misplaced or not attached as specified	x	-	-
	Any slot missing or not fully completed	x	-	-
	Any part damaged, distorted, bent, broken, malformed, not formed as required or otherwise impaired	x	-	-
	Corner of bar not rounded or does not have the required radius when applicable	x	-	-
	Not type material specified	x	-	-
	Burr, rough or sharp edge, fin or sliver	-	-	x
	Clutch fastener will not engage	x	-	-
	Clutch fits loose on prong	-	-	x
	Clutch is punctured	-	-	x
	Prong loose within bar	x	-	-
	Prong not knurled under head	-	-	x
	Exposed surface of prong head not flush with bar	-	-	x
	Component parts not tightly swaged	-	-	x
	Prong is not notched or not notched to the extent specified	-	-	x
Assembly	Any component missing	x	-	-
	Ribbon not properly or uniformly aligned, i.e. stripes not straight and level in the horizontal or vertical plane, as applicable	x	-	-
	Ribbon not tautly stretched over face of clip	-	*	-
	Slot of clip, slot of back strip not in alignment, prohibiting mounting of ribbon attachment	x	-	-

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TABLE III. Defects (Continued)

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION Major (*)	Minor	
	Metal clip exposed more than 1/64 inch (0.04 cm), but not more than 1/32 inch (0.08 cm) on either side.....	x	-	-
	Clip is loosely or tightly clinched over the back strip, i.e, bar requires excessive force to slide laterally or bar slips laterally with little or no force.....	x	-	-
Marking	Missing, incorrect, illegible.....	-	-	x
	Not accomplished as specified or not placed as required.....	-	-	x

4.5.4.1.2 Examination of the service ribbon or service bar for defects in dimensions. Any dimension which is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample shall be one completely finished service ribbon or service bar.

4.5.4.1.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's). The inspection levels and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection Level	AQL Major	Total
For defects applicable to 4.5.4.1.1	II	2.5	10.0
For defects applicable to 4.5.4.1.2	S-3	(one class)	4.0

4.5.4.1.4 End item testing. Testing of the completely fabricated service ribbons and service bars shall be performed in accordance with Table IV for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit shall be two completely fabricated service ribbons or service bars, as applicable. The requirements are applicable to the individual unit. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. End items tests

Characteristic	Requirement Paragraph	Test Method	# determ Per Sample /Unit	Results Reported as
Chemical composition test	3.3.1	4.6.1	1	Pass or Fail
Test for prong and clutch type	3.4.1	4.6.2	1	Pass or Fail
Test for hard soldering	3.4.2.1	4.6.3	1	Pass or Fail
Test for fused joints	3.4.2.1	4.6.4	1	Pass or Fail

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4.5.4.2 Examination for count of service ribbon or service bar for intermediate containers. Service ribbons or service bars packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with package markings and specified quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (intermediate container). The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers. Any box containing less than the specified marked quantity of backing plates shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per sample unit.

4.5.4.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of Section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

EXAMINE	DEFECT
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping or taping, inadequate strapping. Bulging or distortion of containers.
Content	Number of intermediate packages is more or less than required.
Weight	Net weight exceeds requirements. More than one type and size service ribbon bar packaged or packed, per intermediate container.

4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 Chemical composition test. The chemical composition shall be determined in accordance with Test Method 111 of FED-STD-151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.3.1.

4.6.2 Test for clutch fasteners. The clutches shall be removed and replaced 10 times from the prongs using the clutch release wings. An attempt shall be made to remove the clutch by hand without first pressing the release wings, during which time the clutch and prong shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.4.1.

4.6.3 Test for hard solder. Hard soldered items shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1075 degrees Fahrenheit ± 5 degrees Fahrenheit (561.7 degrees Celsius ± 2.78 degrees Celsius) for 15 minutes. While at this temperature the item shall be lifted by the attaching device and shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.4.2.1.

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4.6.4 Test for electronically fused joints. Item to be tested shall be anchored on a horizontal surface. All prongs on each item shall be grasped at least one third its length above the fused joint and bent through an angle of 90 degrees (45 degrees to each side of the vertical) until the prong breaks. The fused joint shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.4.2.1. A bending tool in the form of a 45 degree template may be used for this test provided the prong is gripped at least one third its length above the fused joint.

4.7 Packaging Inspection. The preservation, packing and marking shall be inspected to verify conformance to the requirements of Section 5.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be Level C or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level C. Two hundred service (200) ribbons, two hundred (200) Size 1 or Size 2 ribbon bars, one hundred (100) Size 3 or Size 4 ribbon bars of one type or size only shall be packaged in a snug-fitting paper board box conforming to Variety 1, Style III or IV, Type I, Class A of PPP-B-676. Closure shall be in accordance with the container specification.

5.1.2 Commercial. Backing plates packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level C or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level C. Twelve thousand (12,000) service ribbons, eight thousand (8,000) Size 1 or Size 2 ribbon bars or forty four hundred (4,400) Size 3 or Size 4 ribbon bars of one type or size only packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to Class Domestic, Grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Closure of the box shall be in accordance with Method II of the appendix of the box specification. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed the size and weight limitations of the container specification.

5.2.2 Commercial. Backing plates packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.3 Palletization. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type 1A of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C, K and L or O or P. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. The pallet shall be 4-way, Type I, Class 1, Style 1, Size A, Wood Group I, II, III or IV of MIL-P-15011, or, 4-way, Type IV, V or VIII, Class 1, Style A, Size 2, Wood Group I, II, III or IV, Grade A of NN-P-71. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM-D-3951 as applicable.

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5.5 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.7.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. Service ribbons covered by this specification are intended to be worn on military uniforms to identify the decorations, citations, awards and campaign or service medals received by the individual. The service ribbon bars are intended to be used in mounting the service ribbon on the uniform.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1).

c. Type of service ribbon required when applicable (see 1.2.1).

d. Size of service ribbon bar when applicable (see 1.2.2)

e. When a first article is not required (see 3.1).

f. Whether a standard sample is to be furnished (see 3.2).

g. Ribbon required (see 3.3.2).

h. Drawings (see 2.1.2 and 3.4).

i. Spacing required between ribbon rows for Army ribbons (see 3.4.3.3).

j. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

k. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 First article. When first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the item should be a preproduction sample, a first production sample or a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory (see 3.1), and the number of items to be tested as specified in 4.4. The first article should consist of one completed backing plate. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results, and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or tests, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract. Bidders

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should not submit alternate bids unless specifically requested to do so in the solicitation.

6.4 Standard sample. For access to standard samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation to bid (see 3.2).

6.5 Type III Service ribbons. Type III service ribbons are not in the DOD supply system but may be ordered through the Army Air Force Exchange Systems (AAFES) or commercial sources under procedures established by these sources.

6.6 Subject term (key word) listing.

Medal
Awards
Decoration
Clutch
Buckram
Clip

6.7 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Navy - NU
Air Force - 11
Coast Guard - CG

Review activities:
Navy - MC
Air Force - 82, 99
DLA - CT

User activities:
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

(Project No. 8455-0695)

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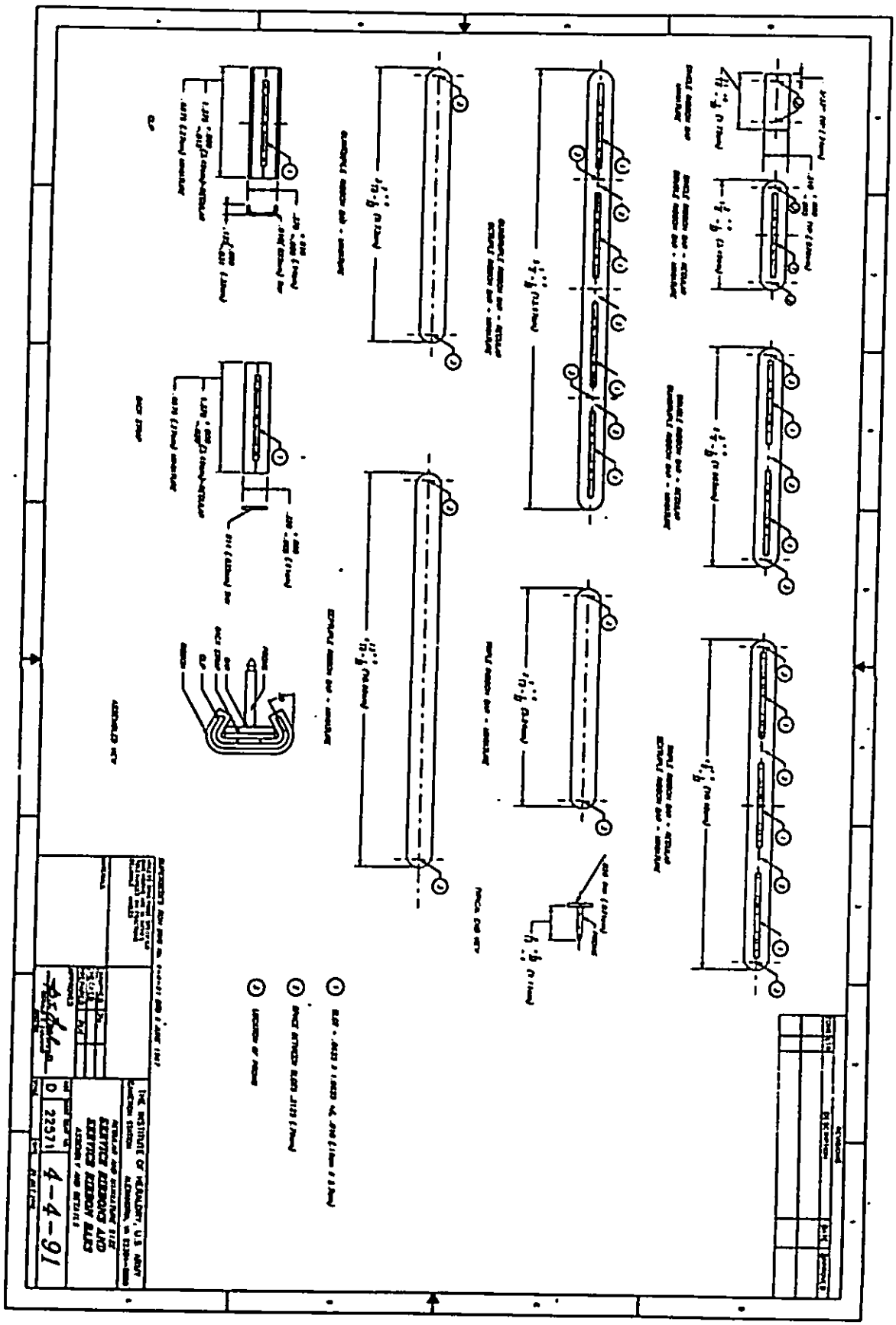


FIGURE 1. Service Ribbons and Service Ribbon Bars; Assembly and Details

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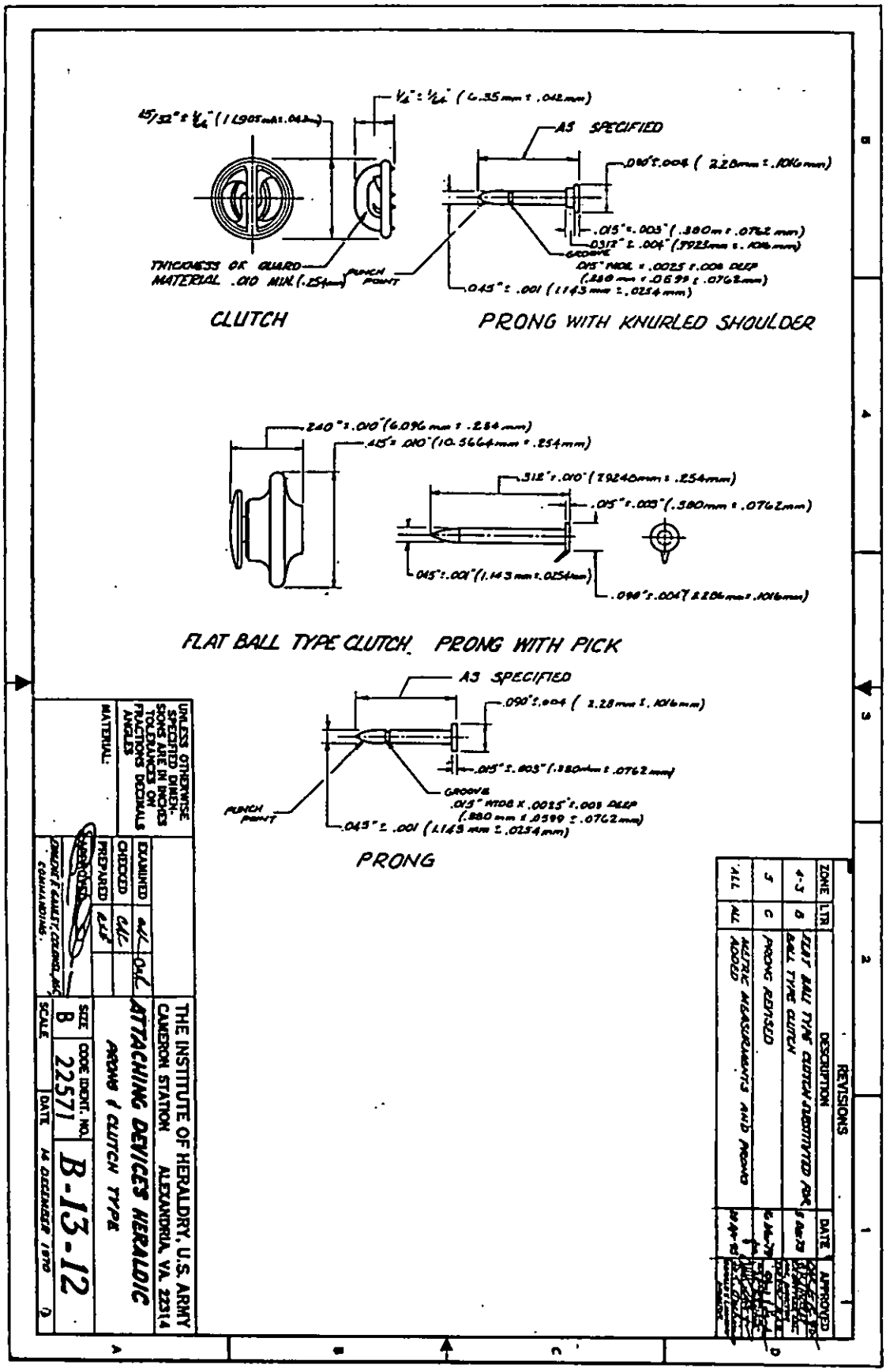


FIGURE 2. Attaching Devices, Heraldic, Prong and Clutch Type

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

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2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-S-3951D	930423

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
SERVICE RIBBONS AND BARS, SERVICE RIBBONS

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
The Institute of Heraldry	(202). 274-6636	284-6636
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Bldg 15, Technical & Production Division Cameron Station Alexandria, VA 22304-5050	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 *Previous editions are obsolete.* 198/290

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